

Question 33 · Unit 2 · 8 Marks

Analyse how poor coordination among HRD subsystems can reduce the effectiveness of employee development.

Introduction

Poor coordination means each HRD subsystem works in its own silo: appraisal does not talk to training, training does not talk to career, potential labels do not change promotions, counselling never happens after the rating. Effectiveness of employee development means people actually become more capable, more ready for future roles, and more able to work together. Analysis must show broken links → contradictory messages → wasted effort → low development, and then a vicious cycle of lost credibility.

Detailed points

- 1. Appraisal not feeding training.** Employees are rated weak on a skill year after year but never trained or coached. They conclude the organisation is not serious. The gap remains. Development effectiveness is zero for that skill despite 'complete' appraisal files.
- 2. Training unrelated to career and work.** People attend courses that do not lead to any new responsibility or even to a chance to practise. Motivation to learn falls. Transfer fails. Development looks busy (attendance) and is ineffective (no capability on the job).
- 3. Potential ignored when promotions happen.** HRD says someone is high potential; the actual promotion goes by seniority or politics. High-potential staff leave. Others see HRD as a lie. Effectiveness of talent development collapses because the most important career actions ignore HRD data.
- 4. No counselling after appraisal.** Numbers are written; no conversation, no emotional support, no joint plan. Data without insight. People who needed help with stress or role confusion stay stuck. Development is not only cognitive; counselling's absence reduces effectiveness for whole-person growth.
- 5. Conflicting messages between subsystems.** Training teaches teamwork; appraisal and bonus honour only individual targets. Employees follow the reward. Net development of collaboration can be negative — the organisation is less developed after 'HRD activity' than before. This is a key analytical point.
- 6. Duplication, gaps and no memory.** Two cells run similar programmes; some roles get nothing. Without a shared file, each year starts from zero. Inefficiency plus inequity. Development is uneven and unfair, which also violates HRD's equity objective.
- 7. Climate damage.** Uncoordinated HRD feels chaotic and political. Trust falls. In a weaker climate, even the remaining good practices transfer less. Poor coordination therefore reduces effectiveness both directly (broken links) and indirectly (worse soil).
- 8. Vicious cycle of credibility.** When development does not happen, business heads cut HRD budget. Subsystems shrink further and coordinate even less. Employee development slows again. Analysis should end with this loop so the examiner sees you understand dynamics, not only a list of problems.

Conclusion. Poor coordination breaks the chain from diagnosis to learning to career to new behaviour, sends conflicting messages, wastes money, and damages climate and credibility. Employee development then becomes slow, unfair and unstrategic. Coordination is a condition of HRD effectiveness, not a luxury.